Pre-screening Assessment – Paycode

Stage 1 Target entry: Series A+

Website	https://www.paycode.com/	**Round / Stage**	Series A	**Date**	June 2, 2026
HQ Geo	South Africa (UK registered)	**Valuation**	$42M pre-money	**Lead**	Kevin Dillon

Company profile

Company description & market opportunity

PayCode is a biometric last mile verification company enabling last-mile financial inclusion for unbanked and underbanked populations in emerging markets, with a proprietary smart card that supports fully offline transactions, identity verification, and account top-ups across 10 countries with 6M+ users. Key institutional partners include the World Bank, UNOPS, UNDP, UNHCR, Mastercard, and Visa, with the UN exploring white-label deployment of PayCode for last-mile payment distribution.

Founder quality / founder-market fit

Strong team with CEO Gabriel Ruhan scaled Global Switch (turnover $72M) and Navisite (revenue $154M); Founder/CRO Ralph Pecker co-founded 3 JSE-listed fintechs. The rest of the C-suite and non-executive members add depth with diverse experience spanning central banking (SARB, Central Bank of Malawi), global payments networks, health insurance IT, financial automation, and business development.

Key risk / initial red flag *[E.g. customer concentration dependency, regulatory, etc.]*

Dependence on humanitarian/donor cycles (UN, World Bank) in fragile-state deployments (Sudan, Afghanistan, DRC) which can create complexity in procurement.

Total Capital Raised ($m)	Most Recent Financing Date	Estimated Cash Runway (Months)	Active Term Sheet Received	Key Financing Terms *[Investor Name, Valuation, Round Size, Commitments, etc.]*
~$13.8M		n/a	☒	Kickstart Seed Fund VI, $4-5m committed. Round max of $10m

Screening criteria

Category	Assessment notes	Score	Revisit Trigger
1. Strategic & fund fit *Unique IP/tech that is a value multiplier* *Global/Global South applicable* *Market opportunity supports venture-scale outcome* *No active portfolio conflicts*	Proprietary offline biometric payment rail is genuine IP with no identified direct competitor. Squarely Global South-focused with proven deployments across Africa and beyond. Last-mile fintech at scale is a venture-size opportunity.	4/5	☐
2. Commercial maturity *Revenue-generating, deployable product* *Emerging scalable market pull* *Strong commercial momentum*	Revenue-generating with live deployments in 10 countries and 7M+ users. Donor and bank channel partnerships (UN, World Bank, Mastercard, Visa) provide institutional validation. Growth in 2025 driven by long-term contract wins in 2024 (Sudan, USAID Zambia). Recurring revenue was nascent at 11% of 2024 total (16% and 32% forecasted in 2025/26).	5/5	☐
3. Team *Leadership has scaling track record* *Delivers on technical and commercial milestones*	CEO and Founder/CRO have credible scaling track records (Global Switch, Navisite, 3 JSE-listed startups). Non-execs are exceptionally strong for the stage (former Mastercard president, SARB veterans). Company has delivered successive product and country milestones across multiple funding rounds.	5/5	☐
4. Entry economics *Valuation consistent with ABF return targets (Min 3× in 4 years)* *Sufficient ownership (10%) achievable at entry price/round conditions* *Round structure is investable*	$42M pre-money at ~5.4x 2025 projected revenue ($7.8M) is reasonable for a high-growth fintech with this trajectory. 3x in 4 years requires ~$126M exit valuation, plausible at projected 2028 revenue ($36.9M) on an 8-15x fintech multiple, but fully dependent on hitting revenue projections. 10% ownership achievable only if ABF participates meaningfully in the current $10M round; Kickstart anchoring at up to $5M leaves limited room.	4/5	☐
5. Exit profile *Plausible exit (M&A) path within 3-4 years* *Company attractive to [identified] acquirers at exit*	Strong M&A appeal to Visa and Mastercard (both already partners), major remittance players, and multilateral-backed fintech acquirers. The proprietary offline rail and biometric KYC are strategically valuable and may not be trivial to replicate. 3-4 year exit horizon is tight but not implausible if 2025-2026 growth materializes..	4/5	☐
6. ABF value-add *Meaningful operational or network value-add opportunity* *Clear opportunity for ABF contribution*	The CEO's prior Atlantic Bridge exit means Africa Bridge can be a trusted partner whose network and advisors can add immediate, relevant value on GTM execution and exit strategy.	5/5	☐
7. Process & timing *Round timing fits deployment window* *No legal or governance blocker*	Term sheet signed December 16, 2025; round is live. Exclusivity window (60 days from signing) expired that can be extended by mutual consent – team awaiting ABF feedback to the close the round. No legal or governance blockers identified, though conversion of parent entity to Delaware C-corp is a closing condition that adds some process complexity.	5/5	☐

Conclusion *[Section to be completed during screening meeting]*

Notes

- Validate impact or dependence on humanitarian donor cycles / public procurement as well as how contracts are won and sales-cycle length
- Understand recurring vs other revenue and what portion of revenue is currently recurring

1 ☒ **Engage immediately** Commence DD. Round in 3–6 months	**2** ☐ **Keep close** Round expected within 6–12 months	**3** ☐ **Watchlist** Revisit when trigger satisfied	**4** ☐ **Not a fit** Provide feedback; no further systematic follow-up required